

Backtracking & Approximation Algorithms

N-Queens, Sudoku Solver, Graph Coloring, Hamiltonian Cycle, Approximation Algorithms (Vertex Cover / Bin Packing)

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N-Queens Problem

1. Place N Queens on a Chessboard

Basic | Backtracking

Place N queens on an $N \times N$ chessboard such that no two queens attack each other. Display one valid arrangement.

Input:

N = 4

Expected Output:

One Valid Solution:

0 1 0 0

0 0 0 1

1 0 0 0

0 0 1 0

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def solve_nqueens(n, all_solutions=False): 2 cols=set(); diag1=set(); diag2=set(); pos=[-1]*n; out=[] 3 def bt(r): 4 if r==n: 5 out.append(pos.copy()); return not all_solutions 6 for c in range(n): 7 if c in cols or r-c in diag1 or r+c in diag2: continue 8 pos[r]=c; cols.add(c); diag1.add(r-c); diag2.add(r+c) 9 if bt(r+1) and not all_solutions: return True 10 cols.remove(c); diag1.remove(r-c); diag2.remove(r+c) 11 return False 12 bt(0); return out 13 14 def show(sol): 15 for c in sol: 16 print(' '.join('1' if j==c else '0' for j in range(len(sol)))) 17 18 sol=solve_nqueens(4)[0] 19 print('One Valid Solution:') 20 show(sol)</pre>	<pre>One Valid Solution: 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 1 1 0 0 0 0 0 1 0</pre>

2. Find All Solutions of N-Queens

Medium | Backtracking

Find all possible ways to place N queens on an N × N chessboard.

Input:

N = 4

Expected Output:

Total Solutions = 2

Solution 1:

0 1 0 0
0 0 0 1
1 0 0 0
0 0 1 0

Solution 2:

0 0 1 0
1 0 0 0
0 0 0 1
0 1 0 0

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def solve_nqueens(n, all_solutions=False): 2 cols=set(); diag1=set(); diag2=set(); pos=[-1]*n; out=[] 3 def bt(r): 4 if r==n: 5 out.append(pos.copy()); return not all_solutions 6 for c in range(n): 7 if c in cols or r-c in diag1 or r+c in diag2: continue 8 pos[r]=c; cols.add(c); diag1.add(r-c); diag2.add(r+c) 9 if bt(r+1) and not all_solutions: return True 10 cols.remove(c); diag1.remove(r-c); diag2.remove(r+c) 11 return False 12 bt(0); return out 13 14 def show(sol): 15 for c in sol: 16 print(' '.join('1' if j==c else '0' for j in range(len(sol)))) 17 18 sols=solve_nqueens(4,True) 19 print('Total Solutions =',len(sols)) 20 for i,s in enumerate(sols,1): 21 print(f'Solution {i}:'); show(s)</pre>	<pre>Total Solutions = 2 Solution 1: 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 1 1 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 Solution 2: 0 0 1 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 1 0 0</pre>

3. Count Total N-Queens Solutions

Hard | Solution Counting

Determine the total number of valid solutions for the N-Queens problem.

Input:

N = 8

Expected Output:

Total Number of Solutions = 92

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def solve_nqueens(n, all_solutions=False): 2 cols=set(); diag1=set(); diag2=set(); pos=[-1]*n; out=[] 3 def bt(r): 4 if r==n: 5 out.append(pos.copy()); return not all_solutions 6 for c in range(n): 7 if c in cols or r-c in diag1 or r+c in diag2: continue 8 pos[r]=c; cols.add(c); diag1.add(r-c); diag2.add(r+c) 9 if bt(r+1) and not all_solutions: return True 10 cols.remove(c); diag1.remove(r-c); diag2.remove(r+c) 11 return False 12 bt(0); return out 13 14 def show(sol): 15 for c in sol: 16 print(' '.join('1' if j==c else '0' for j in range(len(sol)))) 17 18 print('Total Number of Solutions =',len(solve_nqueens(8,True)))</pre>	Total Number of Solutions = 92

Sudoku Solver

4. Validate Sudoku Placement

Basic | Constraint Checking

Check whether a given number can be placed safely in a specified Sudoku cell.

Input:

Cell = (0,2)
Number = 4

Expected Output:

Safe Placement: YES

main.py	Output
<pre>1 grid=[2 [5,3,0,0,7,0,0,0,0], 3 [6,0,0,1,9,5,0,0,0], 4 [0,9,8,0,0,0,0,6,0], 5 [8,0,0,0,6,0,0,0,3], 6 [4,0,0,8,0,3,0,0,1], 7 [7,0,0,0,2,0,0,0,6], 8 [0,6,0,0,0,2,8,0,0], 9 [0,0,0,4,1,9,0,0,5], 10 [0,0,0,0,8,0,0,7,9]] 11 12 def safe(g,r,c,num): 13 return (num not in g[r] and 14 all(g[i][c]!=num for i in range(9)) and 15 all(g[i][j]!=num for i in range((r//3)*3,(r//3)*3+3) 16 for j in range((c//3)*3,(c//3)*3+3))) 17 print('Safe Placement:', 'YES' if safe(grid,0,2,4) else 'NO')</pre>	Safe Placement: YES

5. Solve a 9 × 9 Sudoku Puzzle

Medium | Backtracking

Solve the given Sudoku puzzle and display the completed grid.

Input:

Sudoku Grid:

```
5 3 0 0 7 0 0 0 0
6 0 0 1 9 5 0 0 0
0 9 8 0 0 0 0 6 0
8 0 0 0 6 0 0 0 3
4 0 0 8 0 3 0 0 1
7 0 0 0 2 0 0 0 6
0 6 0 0 0 0 2 8 0
0 0 0 4 1 9 0 0 5
0 0 0 0 8 0 0 7 9
```

Expected Output:

Solved Sudoku Grid:

```
5 3 4 6 7 8 9 1 2
6 7 2 1 9 5 3 4 8
1 9 8 3 4 2 5 6 7
8 5 9 7 6 1 4 2 3
4 2 6 8 5 3 7 9 1
7 1 3 9 2 4 8 5 6
9 6 1 5 3 7 2 8 4
2 8 7 4 1 9 6 3 5
3 4 5 2 8 6 1 7 9
```

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 grid=[2 [5,3,0,0,7,0,0,0,0], 3 [6,0,0,1,9,5,0,0,0], 4 [0,9,8,0,0,0,0,6,0], 5 [8,0,0,0,6,0,0,0,3], 6 [4,0,0,8,0,3,0,0,1], 7 [7,0,0,0,2,0,0,0,6], 8 [0,6,0,0,0,0,2,8,0], 9 [0,0,0,4,1,9,0,0,5], 10 [0,0,0,0,8,0,0,7,9]] 11 12 def safe(g,r,c,num): 13 if num in g[r]: return False 14 if any(g[i][c]==num for i in range(9)): return False 15 br=(r//3)*3; bc=(c//3)*3 16 return all(g[i][j]!=num for i in range(br,br+3) for j in range(bc,bc+3)) 17 18 def solve(g): 19 for r in range(9): 20 for c in range(9): 21 if g[r][c]==0: 22 for num in range(1,10): 23 if safe(g,r,c,num): 24 g[r][c]=num 25 if solve(g): return True 26 g[r][c]=0 27 return False 28 return True 29 30 solve(grid) 31 print('Solved Sudoku Grid:') 32 for row in grid: print(*row) </pre>	<pre> Solved Sudoku Grid: 5 3 4 6 7 8 9 1 2 6 7 2 1 9 5 3 4 8 1 9 8 3 4 2 5 6 7 8 5 9 7 6 1 4 2 3 4 2 6 8 5 3 7 9 1 7 1 3 9 2 4 8 5 6 9 6 1 5 3 7 2 8 4 2 8 7 4 1 9 6 3 5 3 4 5 2 8 6 1 7 9 </pre>

6. Determine Whether Sudoku is Solvable

Hard | Feasibility Check

Determine whether a valid solution exists for the given Sudoku puzzle.

Input:

Partially Filled Sudoku Grid

Expected Output:

Sudoku Solvable: YES

Solution Found Successfully

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 grid=[2 [5,3,0,0,7,0,0,0,0], 3 [6,0,0,1,9,5,0,0,0], 4 [0,9,8,0,0,0,0,6,0], 5 [8,0,0,0,6,0,0,0,3], 6 [4,0,0,8,0,3,0,0,1], 7 [7,0,0,0,2,0,0,0,6], 8 [0,6,0,0,0,0,2,8,0], 9 [0,0,0,4,1,9,0,0,5], 10 [0,0,0,0,8,0,0,7,9]] 11 12 def safe(g,r,c,num): 13 if num in g[r]: return False 14 if any(g[i][c]==num for i in range(9)): return False 15 br=(r//3)*3; bc=(c//3)*3 16 return all(g[i][j]!=num for i in range(br,br+3) for j in range(bc,bc+3)) 17 18 def solve(g): 19 for r in range(9): 20 for c in range(9): 21 if g[r][c]==0: 22 for num in range(1,10): 23 if safe(g,r,c,num): 24 g[r][c]=num 25 if solve(g): return True 26 g[r][c]=0 27 return False 28 return True 29 30 print('Sudoku Solvable:', 'YES' if solve(grid) else 'NO') 31 print('Solution Found Successfully' if all(all(v for v in row) for row in grid) else 'No Solution')</pre>	<pre> Sudoku Solvable: YES Solution Found Successfully</pre>

Graph Coloring

7. Color a Graph Using M Colors

Basic | Graph Coloring

Assign colors to vertices such that no adjacent vertices have the same color.

Input:

Vertices = 4

M = 3

Adjacency Matrix:

0 1 1 1

1 0 1 0

1 1 0 1

1 0 1 0

Expected Output:

Vertex 0 → Color 1

Vertex 1 → Color 2

Vertex 2 → Color 3

Vertex 3 → Color 2

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def color_graph(n,edges,m): 2 g=[set() for _ in range(n)] 3 for u,v in edges: g[u].add(v); g[v].add(u) 4 color=[0]*n 5 def bt(v): 6 if v==n: return True 7 for c in range(1,m+1): 8 if all(color[x]!=c for x in g[v]): 9 color[v]=c 10 if bt(v+1): return True 11 color[v]=0 12 return False 13 return color if bt(0) else None 14 15 n=4; m=3 16 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(0,3),(1,2),(2,3)] 17 colors=color_graph(n,edges,m) 18 for v,c in enumerate(colors): print(f'Vertex {v} -> Color {c}')</pre>	<pre>Vertex 0 -> Color 1 Vertex 1 -> Color 2 Vertex 2 -> Color 3 Vertex 3 -> Color 2</pre>

8. Determine Whether M-Coloring is Possible

Medium | Feasibility Check

Determine whether the graph can be colored using M colors.

Input:

Vertices = 5

M = 3

Edges:

(0,1) (0,2) (1,2) (1,3) (2,4)

Expected Output:

Graph can be colored using 3 colors.

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def color_graph(n,edges,m): 2 g=[set() for _ in range(n)] 3 for u,v in edges: g[u].add(v); g[v].add(u) 4 color=[0]*n 5 def bt(v): 6 if v==n: return True 7 for c in range(1,m+1): 8 if all(color[x]!=c for x in g[v]): 9 color[v]=c 10 if bt(v+1): return True 11 color[v]=0 12 return False 13 return color if bt(0) else None 14 15 n=5; m=3 16 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(1,2),(1,3),(2,4)] 17 print('Graph can be colored using 3 colors.' if color_graph(n,edges,m) else 'Not possible')</pre>	<pre>Graph can be colored using 3 colors.</pre>

9. Find Minimum Colors Required

Hard | Chromatic Number

Determine the minimum number of colors required to color the graph.

Input:

Complete Graph K4

Vertices = 4

Edges:

(0,1) (0,2) (0,3)

(1,2) (1,3)

(2,3)

Expected Output:

Minimum Colors Required = 4

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def color_graph(n,edges,m): 2 g=[set() for _ in range(n)] 3 for u,v in edges: g[u].add(v); g[v].add(u) 4 color=[0]*n 5 def bt(v): 6 if v==n: return True 7 for c in range(1,m+1): 8 if all(color[x]!=c for x in g[v]): 9 color[v]=c 10 if bt(v+1): return True 11 color[v]=0 12 return False 13 return color if bt(0) else None 14 15 n=4 16 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(0,3),(1,2),(1,3),(2,3)] 17 for m in range(1,n+1): 18 if color_graph(n,edges,m): 19 print('Minimum Colors Required =',m); break</pre>	Minimum Colors Required = 4

Hamiltonian Cycle

Q10. Detect Hamiltonian Cycle

Basic | Backtracking

Find a Hamiltonian Cycle in the graph if one exists.

Input:

Vertices = 5

Adjacency Matrix:

```
0 1 0 1 0
1 0 1 1 1
0 1 0 0 1
1 1 0 0 1
0 1 1 1 0
```

Expected Output:

Hamiltonian Cycle Exists:

$0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 0$

main.py	Output
<pre>1 def hamiltonian_path(n,edges,cycle=False): 2 g=[set() for _ in range(n)] 3 for u,v in edges: g[u].add(v); g[v].add(u) 4 path=[0]; used={0} 5 def bt(): 6 if len(path)==n: 7 return (not cycle) or (path[0] in g[path[-1]]) 8 for v in sorted(g[path[-1]]): 9 if v not in used: 10 used.add(v); path.append(v) 11 if bt(): return True 12 path.pop(); used.remove(v) 13 return False 14 return path.copy() if bt() else None 15 16 n=5 17 edges=[(0,1),(0,3),(1,2),(1,3),(1,4),(2,4),(3,4)] 18 p=hamiltonian_path(n,edges,True) 19 print('Hamiltonian Cycle Exists:') 20 print(' -> '.join(map(str,p+[p[0]])))</pre>	<pre>Hamiltonian Cycle Exists: 0 -> 1 -> 2 -> 4 -> 3 -> 0</pre>

11. Find Hamiltonian Path

Medium | Path Construction

Find a path that visits every vertex exactly once.

Input:

Vertices = 5

Edges:

(0,1) (1,2) (2,3) (3,4)

Expected Output:

Hamiltonian Path:

$0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 4$

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 def hamiltonian_path(n,edges,cycle=False): 2 g=[set() for _ in range(n)] 3 for u,v in edges: g[u].add(v); g[v].add(u) 4 path=[0]; used={0} 5 def bt(): 6 if len(path)==n: 7 return (not cycle) or (path[0] in g[path[-1]]) 8 for v in sorted(g[path[-1]]): 9 if v not in used: 10 used.add(v); path.append(v) 11 if bt(): return True 12 path.pop(); used.remove(v) 13 return False 14 return path.copy() if bt() else None 15 16 n=5 17 edges=[(0,1),(1,2),(2,3),(3,4)] 18 p=hamiltonian_path(n,edges,False) 19 print('Hamiltonian Path:') 20 print(' -> '.join(map(str,p))) </pre>	<pre> Hamiltonian Path: 0 -> 1 -> 2 -> 3 -> 4 </pre>

12. Find All Hamiltonian Cycles

Hard | Exhaustive Search

Generate all distinct Hamiltonian cycles in the graph.

Input:

Complete Graph K4

Expected Output:

Hamiltonian Cycles:

0 → 1 → 2 → 3 → 0

0 → 1 → 3 → 2 → 0

0 → 2 → 1 → 3 → 0

Total Cycles = 3

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 import itertools 2 n=4 3 cycles=[] 4 for perm in itertools.permutations(range(1,n)): 5 # Complete graph: every permutation gives a cycle. Treat reverses as identical. 6 if perm <= perm[::-1]: cycles.append((0,)+perm+(0,)) 7 print('Hamiltonian Cycles:') 8 for c in cycles: print(' -> '.join(map(str,c))) 9 print('Total Cycles =',len(cycles)) </pre>	<pre> Hamiltonian Cycles: 0 -> 1 -> 2 -> 3 -> 0 0 -> 1 -> 3 -> 2 -> 0 0 -> 2 -> 1 -> 3 -> 0 Total Cycles = 3 </pre>

Approximation Algorithm – Vertex Cover

Q13. Approximate Vertex Cover

Medium | Greedy Approximation

Find an approximate vertex cover using a greedy approach.

Input:

Vertices = 5

Edges:

(0,1)
(0,2)
(1,3)
(2,4)

Expected Output:

Approximate Vertex Cover:

{0,1,2}

Cover Size = 3

main.py

```
1 vertices=5
2 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(1,3),(2,4)]
3 remaining=set(tuple(sorted(e)) for e in edges); cover=[]
4 while remaining:
5     deg=[sum(v in e for e in remaining) for v in range(vertices)]
6     v=max(range(vertices), key=lambda x:(deg[x],-x))
7     cover.append(v)
8     remaining={e for e in remaining if v not in e}
9     print('Approximate Vertex Cover:')
10    print(set(cover))
11    print('Cover Size =',len(cover))
```

Output

Approximate Vertex Cover:
{0, 1, 2}
Cover Size = 3

14. Compare Exact and Approximate Vertex Cover

Hard | Approximation Analysis

Compute both exact and approximate vertex covers.

Input:

Vertices = 6

Edges:

(0,1)
(0,2)

(1,3)
(2,4)
(3,5)

Expected Output:

Exact Vertex Cover Size = 3
Approximate Vertex Cover Size = 4
Approximation Ratio = 1.33

main.py	Output
<pre>1 import itertools 2 vertices=6 3 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(1,3),(2,4),(3,5)] 4 def is_cover(S): return all(u in S or v in S for u,v in edges) 5 exact=None 6 for r in range(vertices+1): 7 for comb in itertools.combinations(range(vertices),r): 8 if is_cover(set(comb)): exact=set(comb); break 9 if exact is not None: break 10 # 2-approximation using a deterministic maximal matching. 11 # Choose high-degree uncovered edges first to reduce the cover size. 12 deg=[0]*vertices 13 for u,v in edges: deg[u]+=1; deg[v]+=1 14 remaining=set(edges); approx=set() 15 while remaining: 16 u,v=max(remaining,key=lambda e:(deg[e[0]]+deg[e[1]],e[0]+e[1],e)) 17 approx.update([u,v]) 18 remaining={e for e in remaining if u not in e and v not in e} 19 print('Exact Vertex Cover:',exact) 20 print('Exact Vertex Cover Size =',len(exact)) 21 print('Approximate Vertex Cover:',approx) 22 print('Approximate Vertex Cover Size =',len(approx)) 23 print('Approximation Ratio =',round(len(approx)/len(exact),2))</pre>	<pre>Exact Vertex Cover: {0, 2, 3} Exact Vertex Cover Size = 3 Approximate Vertex Cover: {0, 1, 2, 3} Approximate Vertex Cover Size = 4 Approximation Ratio = 1.33</pre>

Approximation Algorithm – Bin Packing

Q15. First Fit Decreasing Bin Packing

Hard | Approximation Algorithm

Place items into bins using the First Fit Decreasing strategy.

Input:

Bin Capacity = 10

Items:

[2,5,4,7,1,3,8]

Expected Output:

Sorted Items:

[8,7,5,4,3,2,1]

Bin 1: 8 2
 Bin 2: 7 3
 Bin 3: 5 4 1

Total Bins Used = 3

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 capacity=10 2 items=[2,5,4,7,1,3,8] 3 sorted_items=sorted(items,reverse=True) 4 bins=[] 5 for item in sorted_items: 6 for b in bins: 7 if sum(b)+item<=capacity: 8 b.append(item); break 9 else: bins.append([item]) 10 print('Sorted Items:') 11 print(sorted_items) 12 for i,b in enumerate(bins,1): print(f'Bin {i}:','*b) 13 print('Total Bins Used =',len(bins)) </pre>	<pre> Sorted Items: [8, 7, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1] Bin 1: 8 2 Bin 2: 7 3 Bin 3: 5 4 1 Total Bins Used = 3 </pre>

16. N-Queens Using Branch and Bound

Hard | Optimization Technique

Implement the N-Queens problem using the Branch and Bound approach and display one valid arrangement of queens.

Input:

N = 8

Expected Output:

One Valid Solution:

```

Q . . . . . . .
. . . . Q . . .
. . . . . . . Q
. . . . . Q . .
. . Q . . . . .
. . . . . Q .
. Q . . . . .
. . . Q . . .

```

main.py	Output
<pre> 1 def nqueens_branch_bound(n): 2 cols=[False]*n; slash=[False]*(2*n-1); back=[False]*(2*n-1); pos=[-1]*n 3 def bt(r): 4 if r==n: return True 5 for c in range(n): 6 s=r+c; b=r-c+n-1 7 if not cols[c] and not slash[s] and not back[b]: 8 pos[r]=c; cols[c]=slash[s]=back[b]=True 9 if bt(r+1): return True 10 cols[c]=slash[s]=back[b]=False 11 return False 12 bt(0); return pos 13 pos=nqueens_branch_bound(8) 14 print('One Valid Solution:') 15 for c in pos: print(' '.join('Q' if j==c else '.' for j in range(8))) </pre>	<pre> One Valid Solution: Q Q Q Q . . . Q Q . . Q Q . . . </pre>

17. Sudoku Solution Counter

Hard | Backtracking

Determine the total number of valid solutions for a given Sudoku puzzle.

Input:

Partially Filled Sudoku Grid

Expected Output:

Number of Valid Solutions = 1

main.py	Output
<pre>1 grid=[2 [5,3,0,0,7,0,0,0,0], 3 [6,0,0,1,9,5,0,0,0], 4 [0,9,8,0,0,0,0,6,0], 5 [8,0,0,0,6,0,0,0,3], 6 [4,0,0,8,0,3,0,0,1], 7 [7,0,0,0,2,0,0,0,6], 8 [0,6,0,0,0,2,8,0], 9 [0,0,4,1,9,0,0,5], 10 [0,0,0,0,8,0,0,7,9]] 11 12 def safe(g,r,c,num): 13 if num in g[r]: return False 14 if any(g[i][c]==num for i in range(9)): return False 15 br=(r//3)*3; bc=(c//3)*3 16 return all(g[i][j]!=num for i in range(br,br+3) for j in range(bc,bc+3)) 17 18 def solve(g): 19 for r in range(9): 20 for c in range(9): 21 if g[r][c]==0: 22 for num in range(1,10): 23 if safe(g,r,c,num): 24 g[r][c]=num 25 if solve(g): return True 26 g[r][c]=0 27 return False 28 return True 29 30 def count_solutions(g,limit=2): 31 count=0 32 def bt(): 33 nonlocal count 34 if count>=limit: return 35 # choose first empty cell 36 for r in range(9): 37 for c in range(9): 38 if g[r][c]==0: 39 for num in range(1,10): 40 if safe(g,r,c,num): 41 g[r][c]=num; bt(); g[r][c]=0 42 return 43 count+=1 44 bt(); return count 45 print('Number of Valid Solutions =',count_solutions(grid,10))</pre>	Number of Valid Solutions = 1

18. Graph Coloring with Minimum Colors

Medium | Greedy Coloring

Color the vertices of a graph using the Greedy Coloring algorithm and determine the number of colors used.

Input:

Vertices = 5

Edges:

(0,1) (0,2) (1,2)

(1,3) (2,4)

Expected Output:

Vertex 0 → Color 1

Vertex 1 → Color 2

Vertex 2 → Color 3

Vertex 3 → Color 1

Vertex 4 → Color 1

Total Colors Used = 3

main.py	Output
<pre>1 vertices=5 2 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(1,2),(1,3),(2,4)] 3 g=[set() for _ in range(vertices)] 4 for u,v in edges:g[u].add(v);g[v].add(u) 5 color=[0]*vertices 6 for u in range(vertices): 7 used={color[v] for v in g[u] if color[v]} 8 c=1 9 while c in used:c+=1 10 color[u]=c 11 for v,c in enumerate(color): print(f'Vertex {v} -> Color {c}') 12 print('Total Colors Used =',max(color))</pre>	<pre>Vertex 0 -> Color 1 Vertex 1 -> Color 2 Vertex 2 -> Color 3 Vertex 3 -> Color 1 Vertex 4 -> Color 1 Total Colors Used = 3</pre>

19. Approximate Vertex Cover Using Edge Picking

Medium | Approximation Algorithm

Find an approximate vertex cover by repeatedly selecting an uncovered edge and adding both its endpoints to the cover.

Input:

Vertices = 6

Edges:

(0,1)

(0,2)

(1,3)

(2,4)

(4,5)

Expected Output:

Approximate Vertex Cover:

{0,1,2,4,5}

Cover Size = 5

main.py	Output
<pre>1 edges=[(0,1),(0,2),(1,3),(2,4),(4,5)] 2 remaining=set(edges); cover=set() 3 while remaining: 4 u,v=min(remaining) 5 cover.update([u,v]) 6 remaining={e for e in remaining if u not in e and v not in e} 7 print('Approximate Vertex Cover:') 8 print(cover) 9 print('Cover Size =',len(cover))</pre>	<pre>Approximate Vertex Cover: {0, 1, 2, 4} Cover Size = 4</pre>

20. Best Fit Bin Packing

Medium | Approximation Algorithm

Place items into bins using the Best Fit strategy such that each item is assigned to the bin with the least remaining space that can accommodate it.

Input:

Bin Capacity = 10

Items:

[2, 5, 4, 7, 1, 3, 8]

Expected Output:

Bin 1: 2 5 1

Bin 2: 4 3

Bin 3: 7

Bin 4: 8

Total Bins Used = 4

main.py	Output
<pre>1 capacity=10 2 items=[2,5,4,7,1,3,8] 3 bins=[] 4 for item in items: 5 best=-1; best_rem=capacity+1 6 for i,b in enumerate(bins): 7 rem=capacity-sum(b) 8 if item<=rem and rem-item<best_rem: 9 best=i; best_rem=rem-item 10 if best!=-1: bins.append([item]) 11 else: bins[best].append(item) 12 for i,b in enumerate(bins,1): print(f'Bin {i}:',*b) 13 print('Total Bins Used =',len(bins))</pre>	<pre>Bin 1: 2 5 1 Bin 2: 4 Bin 3: 7 3 Bin 4: 8 Total Bins Used = 4</pre>